

How to write a testable question

Name: _____

Sort the following questions as either **testable** or **untestable**. Remember that a testable question must have the following:

- ☒ Something is being **changed** ☒ Something is being **measured**

Question	Is something being changed?	Is something being measured?	Testable or untestable?
Are cats smarter than dogs?	Yes / No	Yes / No	Untestable
Which colour is the prettiest?	Yes / No	Yes / No	
Does salt change the boiling point of water?	Yes / No	Yes / No	
Does the amount of sunlight affect plant growth?	Yes / No	Yes / No	
What is the best sport?	Yes / No	Yes / No	
Do heavier objects fall faster?	Yes / No	Yes / No	
Does temperature affect how fast ice melts?	Yes / No	Yes / No	
Is chocolate better than vanilla?	Yes / No	Yes / No	

Using one of your wonderings from the See, Think, Wonder activity to try writing your own testable question using the question stems below:

What will changing the _____ do to the _____?
(What are you changing?) (What are you measuring?)

How does changing the _____ affect the _____?
(What are you changing?) (What are you measuring?)

If we change the _____ how does it affect the _____?
(What are you changing?) (What are you measuring?)

When writing a reasoned prediction, you are making an educated guess that is based on your knowledge about the relationship between two things.

Use the graphic organiser to help you write your reasoned prediction.

1 Testable question

Use one you made on the previous page



2 What am I changing?

*Use the following options:
increase / decrease / with / without / condition 1
versus condition 2*

3 What am I measuring?

*Use the following options:
increase / decrease / stay the same*



4 Prediction

If I do this... then this will happen.



5 Reason

This is because...



Reasoned prediction

Put it all together - prediction + reason in two sentences.
